FORGE Phase 1 · Week 3 · Session 8 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 8: Emotional Regulation" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 8 as written already runs the full two hours (120 minutes). This insert adds three short videos; the run of show has no outside talk (an optional one is listed below). The videos take about ten minutes, and those minutes come out of the Instruction segment, because the videos teach the escalation curve and lead the group through both techniques.

What's in this insert

- **Video 8A, "Emotional Regulation"** (2 min 43 s). A quick recap of Session 7, then the escalation curve on screen, each of the five stages lighting up as it is named (calm, agitated, flooded, crisis, recovery), with "intervene here" marked at Stage 2; the guide's "the further up the curve you go, the harder it is to come back down"; what today holds; and "Regulation isn't weakness. Regulation is strategy." It ends on the check-in question and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 8C, "The Escalation Curve"** (4 min 8 s; added October 2026, plays at the start of Part 1). The guide's "escalation curve visual": all five stages in the guide's words, one at a time, the critical insight, "intervene at Stage 2," and "think about the last time you lost it." It ends on the whole curve with Stage 2 marked "intervene here," held for 90 seconds, so you can teach Part 1 from the screen. Pause on that frame for as long as you need.
- **Video 8B, "Breathe and Ground"** (2 min 31 s). Teaches 4-4-4 breathing, then **leads the room through three full cycles** with an animated guide and 38 seconds of real silence; then **leads 5-4-3-2-1 grounding** one sense at a time, with a pause for each; it ends on a "when to use which" card (breathing for the body, grounding for the mind, STOP for a decision), held for 8 seconds.
- **No talk in the run of show.** The session is full as written; an optional talk is listed below for a make-up session or a segment that runs short.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	**Video 8A, "Emotional Regulation"**	3	Play it as soon as the men are seated.
0:03	Opening Circle	10	Start the round on the question the video ends on (a specific emotion, and whether they tracked). Acknowledge anyone who tracked, even once.
0:13	Review & Reflection	10	As written: "Did anyone catch a body signal?"
0:23		4	

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
	Video 8C, "The Escalation Curve"		Plays at the start of Part 1. It teaches the five stages and ends on the whole curve; leave that frame up.
0:27	Instruction, Part 1: The Escalation Curve	8	With the curve on screen, spend the time on the guide's question: "Think about the last time you lost it. Can you find the moment you were at Stage 2?"
0:35	**Video 8B, "Breathe and Ground"**	3	Plays at the start of Part 2 of the Instruction segment. Before you press play: "Sit up straight, feet on the floor. The video will lead us." Let the silences run; don't talk over them.
0:38	Instruction, Parts 2 and 3 (rest): why it works	17	The video leads one round of each technique but skips most of the explanation. Give the guide's paragraphs on why slow breathing works (stress hormones, "you're telling your brain we're safe") and on using 5-4-3-2-1 on your bunk at night. Then lead a second round of 4-4-4 yourself, as written, or replay the video's breathing section (**0:24 to 1:15**).
0:55	Instruction, Part 4: When to Use What	5	The video ends on this card; leave it on screen while you talk it through.
1:00	Practice: Paired Regulation Coaching	30	As written. Pairs who are unsure of the steps can watch the grounding section of Video 8B again (**1:15 to 2:11**) before they start.
1:30	Debrief & Discussion	20	As written ("Breathing exercises? Really?"). Build the real list of situations.
1:50	Checkout & Assignment	10	As written.

Guided practice in Video 8B

- The breathing guide counts in, hold and out on screen for three cycles (36 seconds), then shows "Notice how you feel" before the narrator comes back. The room is silent for 38 seconds. That is intended.
- The grounding section pauses after each sense (7, 5, 5, 4 and 3 seconds). If the room needs longer, pause the video and let them finish.
- Men who don't want to close their eyes can look at the floor; the narrator says so.

Optional talk (if time allows)

Session 8 already runs two hours, so this talk is not in the run of show above. Use it for a make-up session, when a segment runs short, or for your own preparation before the session.

Guy Winch, ***How to practice emotional first aid*** (TED, filmed at TEDxLinnaeusUniversity 2014, 17 minutes 29 seconds). A psychologist on why we know to bandage a cut but leave emotional wounds alone: loneliness, failure, rumination and harsh self-talk. "We have to catch our unhealthy psychological habits and change them."

Discussion questions:

1. He says everyone learns first aid for a cut, and nobody learns it for a feeling. What did today give you for the moment a feeling floods you (4-4-4 breathing, grounding), and when will you use it this week?
2. He describes rumination: replaying an upsetting scene over and over, long after it is over. Where on the escalation curve does replaying a disrespect take you? What will you do the next time you catch yourself replaying one?
3. He says we talk to ourselves after a failure in ways we would never talk to a friend. After a blow-up, what do you say to yourself? What would you say to a man in your cohort in the same spot?

Preview it first. He speaks plainly about loneliness and rejection (including a statistic on early death) and tells a light story about being searched by a police officer. There is no graphic content.

- **YouTube** (TED): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F2hc2FLOdhI
- Also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/guy_winch_why_we_all_need_to_practice_emotional_first_aid

TED allows a single talk in a single lesson, with credit to TED. A talk that becomes a standing part of a curriculum "may require a separate license," and TED asks that talks not be scraped from its site. FORGE repeats every cohort and the prison has no internet, so write to TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, no-fee, in-prison program. Show it whole and unedited, with TED's title card, and check it against the facility's rules for outside media first.

Getting a copy you can play without internet

All three videos are FORGE's own. Download them from forgementors.org/media.html onto the playback device before the session; they play in any video player and need no internet connection. Captions are burned in.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 8A, 8C and 8B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Volume set so the narration is heard from every chair, and the room quiet enough for the breathing silence
- ☐ The escalation curve in front of the men for Part 1 and the paired exercise: Video 8C's last frame, or the curve drawn on easel paper (a printable chart is planned for the next guide and workbook)